

Google Search Essentials & Webmaster Checklist

A comprehensive developer & creator checklist for technical SEO, indexability, and spam compliance.

1 Technical & Architecture Essentials

- ☐ **SSL / HTTPS Encryption**
Ensure 100% force redirect to https:// with valid SSL padlock.
- ☐ **Mobile-First Responsive Design**
Test on small screens (<380px) ensuring zero horizontal scroll.
- ☐ **Core Web Vitals & Page Speed**
Load time under 2.5s; LCP under 2.0s; FID under 100ms.
- ☐ **WebP Image Compression**
Serve modern .webp formats under 150KB with explicit width/height.
- ☐ **Clean Semantic URLs**
Use readable slugs (e.g., /prompts/cyberpunk) instead of query IDs.
- ☐ **Robots.txt & XML Sitemap**
Ensure robots.txt allows Googlebot; submit sitemap.xml.

2 On-Page HTML & Metadata

- ☐ **Unique & Descriptive Title Tag**
50–60 characters including primary keyword & brand name.
- ☐ **Compelling Meta Description**
140–160 characters summarizing page value & click intent.
- ☐ **Canonical Tag on Every Page**
<link rel="canonical" href="..."> to prevent duplicate penalties.
- ☐ **Strict Single H1 Hierarchy**
Exactly one <h1> per page; logical <h2> and <h3> sub-sections.
- ☐ **Image Alt Text Attributes**
Descriptive alt="..." attributes on all content images.
- ☐ **Social OpenGraph / Twitter Cards**
og:title, og:image, og:description for rich link previews.

3 Content Quality & E-E-A-T

- ☐ **People-First Content Approach**
Build for human visitors first, search engine bots second.
- ☐ **100% Originality & Depth**
Zero scraped/copied content; provide unique insights or utility.
- ☐ **Mandatory Trust & Legal Pages**
Privacy Policy, Terms of Service, About Us, Contact Us.
- ☐ **Clean Internal Linking**
Anchor text linking related topics & categories seamlessly.
- ☐ **Readability & Contrast**
16px body font, high contrast ratio (4.5:1), generous line-height.

4 Google Spam Policies (Avoid Penalties)

- ☒ **NO Keyword Stuffing**
Never repeat keywords unnaturally in sentences or footers.
- ☒ **NO Cloaking / Deceptive Redirects**
Never show different content to Googlebot than to real users.
- ☒ **NO Hidden Text or Links**
No white-on-white text, font-size: 0, or CSS offscreen hacks.
- ☒ **NO Spammy / Paid Link Schemes**
Avoid buying bulk backlinks or participating in PBN networks.
- ☒ **NO Intrusive Interstitial Popups**
No full-screen covering ads immediately on mobile load.

5 Launch Day Verification & Google Free Tool Suite

- ☐ **Google Search Console (GSC)**
Verify domain DNS ownership & submit sitemap.xml immediately.
- ☐ **Google Analytics 4 (GA4)**
Implement measurement tag to track organic traffic & user retention.
- ☐ **URL Inspection & Test Live URL**
Inspect homepage in GSC to ensure no crawl errors or blocked scripts.
- ☐ **PageSpeed Insights Audit**
Run PageSpeed Insights and aim for 90+ Score on Mobile & Desktop.

💡 **Golden Rule:** If your website creates real value for humans, Google algorithms will automatically reward you. **100% Compliant Guide**